

DELHI | Security Check

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KALMADI'S SECURITY DEMAND HAS BEEN TURNED DOWN BY THE HOME MINISTRY

Indian Olympic Association President Suresh Kalmadi is feeling threatened. Since he is the man atop the Commonwealth Games organisation, Kalmadi believes gun-toting securitymen are required around him. According to home ministry officials, Kalmadi also felt that Commonwealth Games are more prestigious than IPL whose chief Lalit Modi was given Z plus cover. The Intelligence Bureau (IB), who assesses threats to public figures, doesn't think Kalmadi's life is in any danger. Kalmadi has repeatedly assured the country that there is no threat to the Games. "If there is no threat to the Games, why should there be any threat to him? He has no reason to feel insecure," says a Home Ministry official. The last word hasn't been said on the issue; Kalmadi wants the home ministry to reconsider and may get his wish with the Government wanting to play safe. But will the IB play ball?

by Bhavna Vij-Aurora

MUMBAI | Fast Track

In a first for any Central Government agency in the country, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) will hire public prosecutors on a contractual basis. The move aims to speed up trials and improve the quality of investigation that will ultimately increase conviction rates. Maharashtra has nominated 30 persons for its Anti-Corruption Bureau. "This will clear the backlog of corruption cases," says Adhim Modak, superintendent of police, CBI, Mumbai.

by Mitali Patel

LUCKNOW | Acting Tough

BOTH MAYAWATI AND THE UTTAR PRADESH GOVERNOR HAVE DEMANDED THAT THE STATE POLICE BEHAVE.

Governor B.L. Joshi will have no more of the Uttar Pradesh police's high handedness. Nor will the chief minister. While Joshi was on his way to Raj Bhavan from the airport, the police deployed for his security caught a man who had strayed into the VVIP route. As the governor watched, the man was thrashed mercilessly. Joshi shot off a letter to the DGP, asking his men to exercise restraint. Even Chief Minister Mayawati, concerned over rising custodial deaths, has issued a similar warning to the police top brass. Perhaps now with the governor and the chief minister issuing strict directives, the state police will mend its brutal ways.

by Subhash Mishra

THE MUGGING OF INDIANS IN ITALY MAY FORCE DELHI TO ISSUE A DEMARCHE.

DELHI | Muggy Affair

After the famous Italian mafia, the land of the Colosseum, pizza and piazzas has become a dreaded destination for Indian travellers. Diplomatic sources say that last week an Indian CEO of a leading Italian company was mugged in Milan by a gang comprising several men—and an old woman. Another leading Indian doctor was mugged by armed men as he prepared to check in at a Best Western hotel in Florence. Alarmed by the increase in violent mugging, the MEA is now planning to issue a demarche to raise India's concerns. Diplomatic sources told INDIA TODAY many such cases have been reported to the Indian mission in Italy. Rome has, however, been cold to Delhi's plea for intimation about these attacks even as the West remains ready to embark on its travel advisory diplomacy if such incidents happen in India.

by Saurabh Shukla



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